Records, on AMD

S&P 500 +1.48% to a fresh record on AMD's Q1 print and Iran peace progress. Nasdaq +2.05%. HUT +35% on $9.8B AI lease. Crude tumbles; gold +2.96%.

THE SESSION

The morning brief framed the AMD print as the validation moment for the AI infrastructure thesis. The session resolved that thesis without ambiguity. AMD opened near +18% and held to the bell at $421.47 (+18.64%) after Q1 EPS of $1.37 on $10.3B revenue and a Q2 guide of approximately $11.2B against ~$10.5B Bloomberg consensus, with Data Center revenue accelerating 57% year-over-year. The chip complex moved with it: NVDA +5.68% to $207.66, TSM +6.36%, LRCX +7.75%, KEYS +3.02%, NXPI +3.83%, QCOM +3.28%, TEL +4.46%. The S&P 500 closed at 7,366.46 (+1.48%), a fresh record. Nasdaq +2.05% to 25,846.21. Russell 2000 +1.47% — small caps participated, confirming the breadth signal Tuesday's tape had opened.

The second narrative ran in parallel. Axios, citing two U.S. officials, reported the White House is close to a one-page Memorandum of Understanding with Iran covering enhanced UN inspections, a 12–15 year halt to enrichment, and gradual sanctions relief. President Trump confirmed progress and stated the United States will receive uranium from Iran. Crude collapsed on the framework — and the energy sleeve with it. VLO −6.61% on refining-margin compression, OKE −4.91% on midstream re-rating, CVX −3.88%, CTRA −8.62% (also pricing the Devon merger close tomorrow and the S&P 500 index exit). NTR −4.44% on the agricultural-commodity read-through.

Gold rallied 2.96% to $4,703 — counterintuitive on a peace headline, but the mechanism is structural: a Hormuz reopening drains the inflation pipeline (oil → PCE → Fed), opening the door to rate cuts in 2026. Real yields compress, the dollar weakens, and the metal extends. AEM, the IOWN gold miner, captured the move with operating leverage: +6.55% to $189.81.

The third story sat outside the macro complex. HUT ended +35.31% at $108.94 after announcing a 15-year, $9.8B triple-net lease at its Beacon Point campus in Texas — 352 MW of AI data center capacity to a high-investment-grade tenant, with renewal options that could lift contracted value to $25.1B. Total contracted backlog across two hyperscale AI campuses now stands at $16.8B. The bitcoin miner has executed the cleanest pivot to AI infrastructure in the sector. MARA carried the read-across at +7.15%.

Two open questions from the morning resolved on a single tape: AMD validated the AI cycle with hard Q2 numbers, and the Iran framework moved a step closer to credible. The setup that emerges is a market with a clearer cyclical path and a Fed with more freedom to act.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

HUT +35.31% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

$9.8B, 15-year triple-net lease for 352 MW at Beacon Point, Texas, to a high-investment-grade AI tenant. Total contracted backlog across two campuses now $16.8B. Confirms the bitcoin-miner-to-AI-landlord pivot at scale.

AMD +18.64% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Q1 EPS $1.37 on $10.3B revenue beat across the board; Data Center +57% year-over-year to $5.78B. Q2 guide of approximately $11.2B sits roughly $700M above consensus. The AI-edge thesis is now earnings-validated.

LRCX +7.75% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Wafer-fab equipment caught the AMD updraft. AI-infrastructure capex commitments validated by the AMD print imply continued etch and deposition tool demand through 2026.

AEM +6.55% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold +2.96% on the Iran de-escalation and dollar weakness. The mechanism is the inflation pipeline draining: lower oil supports a more dovish Fed path. Operating leverage on the gold price translated to a 6.5% equity move.

TSM +6.36% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Foundry read-across from the AMD print. Server CPU growth above 70% year-over-year per AMD management implies sustained 5nm/3nm capacity utilization at the Taiwan fab base.

DECLINERS

CTRA –8.62% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Devon all-stock merger closes tomorrow; CTRA exits the S&P; 500 prior to Thursday's open with Veeva taking the slot. Index-tracker rebalance flow combined with the energy-sector decline drove the move. Shareholders receive 0.70 Devon shares per CTRA share.

VLO –6.61% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Refining margins compress on the crude collapse. The 3-2-1 crack spread inverts the energy-sector tailwind from earlier weeks; the Iran framework remove the supply premium that supported peer pricing.

OKE –4.91% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Midstream re-rating on the crude move. Throughput economics remain intact, but the equity reflects the broader energy-sector compression.

NTR –4.44% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Agricultural-commodity read-through on the inflation pipeline reset. Lower input-cost expectations compress fertilizer pricing power assumptions.

CVX –3.88% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Integrated-major exposure to the crude move. The diplomatic track on Iran threatens to remove the war-risk premium that supported recent reporting cycles.

HOLDINGS NEWS

AMD Q1 print validates the AI infrastructure thesis. Beats across the board: $1.37 EPS on $10.3B revenue, Data Center +57% year-over-year to $5.78B, Q2 guide $11.2B vs ~$10.5B consensus. CEO Lisa Su told CNBC the upward revision reflects accelerating demand for CPUs led by agentic AI growth. Bernstein lifted price target to $525 from $265. BofA notes AMD is positioned to command roughly half the growing server CPU market.

HUT signs $9.8B AI data center lease. 15-year triple-net agreement for 352 MW of capacity at the Beacon Point campus in Nueces County, Texas, with a high-investment-grade tenant. Renewal options could extend total contracted value to $25.1B. Q1 revenue +225% year-over-year to $71M with compute revenue +309%. Total contracted backlog across Beacon Point and River Bend now $16.8B.

CTRA exits the S&P 500 tomorrow on the Devon merger close. Veeva Systems replaces Coterra in the index prior to Thursday's open. CTRA shareholders receive 0.70 Devon shares per share. The combined entity becomes a larger Permian operator; the IOWN integrated-energy sub-sleeve composition reshapes accordingly.

BKH, ATO, FTNT report Q1. Three regulated-utility and security-software names printed today; closing moves were modest: BKH +0.11%, ATO −1.33%, FTNT +0.09%. The earnings prints did not materially shift the rate-sensitive valuation framework or the security-software thesis — the day belonged to chips.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

–0.46%

vs. DVY –0.39% | SPY +1.39%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+3.75%

vs. IUSG +2.25%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +13.25% vs DVY +9.08% / SPY +7.62%
Growth +10.50% vs IUSG +9.43%